

India: States, Regions and Regional Geography

A regional reference covering northern, southern, eastern, western, central and northeastern India, with cities, landscapes, agriculture and industries.

1. Northern India

Northern India includes the Himalayan region and the broad plains formed by major river systems. States and union territories in this broad region have very different elevations, climates and settlement patterns.

The plains support intensive agriculture because of fertile alluvial soils and extensive river systems. Mountain areas have tourism, horticulture, hydropower and distinctive cultural traditions.

- Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand contain extensive Himalayan landscapes.
- Punjab and Haryana are important agricultural regions.

2. Southern India

Southern India includes the Deccan Plateau, coastal plains and major river basins. Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana have distinct physical and cultural environments.

The region includes major information-technology centers, automobile and manufacturing clusters, ports, agricultural areas and tourism destinations.

- Bengaluru is a major technology center.
- Kerala has extensive backwaters and a long Arabian Sea coastline.

3. Western and Central India

Western India includes Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa and Rajasthan, while central India includes Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh. The region contains deserts, plateaus, forests, coastal areas and mineral-rich zones.

Mumbai is a major financial and commercial center. Gujarat has important ports and industrial areas, while Rajasthan is known for its desert landscapes, forts and tourism.

- The Thar Desert occupies much of western Rajasthan.
- Chhattisgarh and parts of Madhya Pradesh contain substantial forest and mineral resources.

Reference Table

Region	Example	Characteristics
North	Himalayan states	Mountains, rivers, tourism
South	Karnataka, Tamil Nadu	Technology, industry, agriculture
West	Gujarat, Maharashtra	Industry, ports, finance
East	Odisha, West Bengal	Deltas, minerals, agriculture
Northeast	Assam, Sikkim	Forests, mountains, biodiversity

4. Eastern India

Eastern India includes West Bengal, Odisha, Bihar and Jharkhand. The region combines fertile plains, plateaus, forests, river deltas and mineral-producing areas.

The Sundarbans form a major mangrove landscape in the Ganga-Brahmaputra delta. Odisha has a long coastline and important temple and maritime traditions.

- Kolkata is an important metropolitan and cultural center.

- Jharkhand is known for mineral resources and industrial activity.

5. Northeast India

The northeastern region includes Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya, Manipur, Mizoram, Nagaland, Tripura and Sikkim. It contains mountains, valleys, forests and major river systems.

The region has high biological and cultural diversity. Tea cultivation is especially associated with Assam, while Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh contain major Himalayan landscapes.

- The Brahmaputra is a major river of Assam.
- Meghalaya is known for very high rainfall in some locations.